

Even if and even though

Teaching guide

Distinguish a condition from an accepted fact.

Understand the distinction

Even though introduces a fact accepted in the sentence: Even though it was raining, we walked. Even if introduces a condition or possibility that does not change the result: Even if it rains, we will walk.

The if clause does not assert that the condition is true. It can refer to a possibility or something already known in context; its job is conditional. For a likely future condition, normally use present tense after if rather than will.

Compare the patterns

ACCEPTED FACT

Even though I was tired, I stayed.

The speaker says they were tired.

CONDITION

Even if I am tired, I will stay.

The plan holds whether or not I am tired.

CONTRAST

It was expensive, but I bought it.

But can express a simpler contrast.

Read each example and notice how its form changes the meaning. Use these distinctions to choose your answers on the following pages.

Check your understanding

Circle one answer for each question. There is one correct choice among the options shown. Check the answer key after choosing.

1. Which asserts rain occurred: Even if it rained / Even though it rained?

- A. Both phrases assert that it rained.
- B. Even if it rained.
- C. Even though it rained.

2. Complete: Even if she ___ late, we will wait. (arrive)

- A. arriving
- B. arrives
- C. arrive

3. Does Even if the shop is closed, I will go prove it is closed?

- A. No. It proves the shop is open.
- B. No. The closure is treated as a condition.
- C. Yes. Even if asserts that the shop is closed.

Choose the best response

Choose the response that fits the situation. Check both its meaning and its grammar.

4. The weather may be bad, but you will go to class either way. Which sentence expresses that plan?

- A. Even if the weather is bad, I will go to class.
- B. Even though the weather is bad, I will go to class.
- C. If the weather is bad, I will stay home.

Review your choices

Use the answer explanations on the next page. If you chose a different answer, find the detail that makes it unsuitable and try the question again.

Practice online

The web lesson gives feedback for the option you select and lets you try again. No written response is required.

Answers and explanation

1. C. Even though it rained.

Even though presents the rain as a fact.

A: Even if can discuss a condition without asserting it happened.

B: Even if presents a condition; even though presents a conceded fact.

2. B. arrives

Use present simple for this future condition.

A: The clause needs a finite verb: she arrives.

C: She takes arrives in this present-simple conditional clause.

3. B. No. The closure is treated as a condition.

The sentence does not establish its truth.

A: The sentence does not establish whether the shop is open or closed.

C: Even if presents the closure as a condition, not an established fact.

4. A. Even if the weather is bad, I will go to class.

Even if presents a possible difficulty that will not change the plan.

B: Even though presents bad weather as a fact; the prompt gives it as a possibility.

C: This changes the plan when the weather is bad.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-32.html

A practical teaching sequence

1. Notice (2 minutes)

Read the comparison examples with the learners. Point out the meaning and form that distinguish each pattern.

2. Choose (4 minutes)

Learners select one option for each of the three checks. Keep the answer key covered. Use the selected option's explanation rather than presenting a generic model as feedback.

3. Apply (5 minutes)

The weather may be bad, but you will go to class either way. Which sentence expresses that plan?

Learners choose the response that fits this situation. All responses in this activity are multiple choice; do not replace the choices with a written-answer task.

4. Review (3 minutes)

Compare selected options with the key. Use the option-specific notes to explain why a distractor does not fit. Let learners change their selection and try again.

Scope of the answer key

Each question has one correct option among the choices shown. This does not mean that every other way to express the idea is wrong. Preserve the qualifications in the teaching notes.

Feedback criteria

Check both grammatical form and the stated situation. A correct option answers this question; four correct choices do not certify a learner's overall proficiency.